

GSN Customer Discovery Workshop

Working Plan for RGU / Nigerian Society Pilot

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Status: Clean working brief for review and phone walkthrough

1. What We Are Doing

We are preparing a customer discovery workshop with members of the Nigerian Society at Robert Gordon University.

The session is not a product launch, technical lecture, or sales pitch. It is a guided test of one core idea:

GSN helps a person turn community trust into evidence they can carry into a new place.

The workshop should test whether students understand that idea, believe it, challenge it, and can tell us what evidence would make it stronger.

2. The Core Claim

GSN is not only a contribution app, savings tool, ROSCA platform, shop, or marketplace.

Those activities matter because they create evidence.

The bigger claim is:

A person can build trust inside one community, GSN can record the evidence behind that trust, and the person can later show that evidence in another setting where they are not personally known.

Example:

Amara builds a trusted record in Lagos. Later, she arrives in Aberdeen. People there do not know her personally. Instead of starting from zero, she can show a Trust Passport or TrustSlip so a society member, merchant, employer, or support network can check whether there is real community-backed evidence behind her.

This is the wedge the workshop must test.

3. The Demo Story

Use one simple story throughout the demo:

Amara belongs to a trusted community in Lagos. She contributes, supports others, operates a small shop, and keeps personal commitments. Over time, GSN records her trust story. Later, she arrives in Aberdeen. She can now show a Trust Passport or TrustSlip so someone outside Lagos can make a more informed decision about whether to support, trade with, refer, or trust her.

The question is not whether the app has many pages.

The question is:

Can the app make Amara's trust portable and believable?

4. What TrustSlip Must Answer

Every TrustSlip review should quickly answer four plain questions for the reader:

1. **Can this person be trusted for support, contribution, finance discipline, or trade?**
2. **Do they follow through after receiving support, credit, goods, opportunity, or community benefit?**
3. **Are they stable inside a real community, and is their attitude consistent across community settings?**
4. **Is there verified history behind what they claim?**

The TrustSlip should not make the decision for the reader. It should help the reader decide what to do next:

- proceed carefully
- ask for more evidence
- reduce the amount or risk
- do not rely on the TrustSlip

5. Evidence The TrustSlip Should Show

The TrustSlip should be checked against these evidence areas:

1. **Validity:** current, expired, revoked, frozen, or inactive.
2. **Identity:** GSN/GMFN ID, holder name, phone verification, and community context.
3. **Trust reading:** trust band, CCI, trust limit, and what the limit does and does not mean.
4. **Contribution discipline:** expected contributions, completed contributions, missed or late contributions, and completed cycles where available.
5. **Support and repayment behavior:** support received, support repaid, last full repayment, active obligations, and last merchant release where available.
6. **Personal commitment discipline:** goals set, check-ins made, milestones reached, commitments completed, and missed commitments where reported.
7. **Community and sponsor evidence:** verified sponsor signals, community standing, active community count, and governance/admin verification.
8. **Risk and limits:** overexposure, disputes, risk flags, correction path, expiry, and clear disclaimer.

Important truth:

Personal commitments are useful evidence of follow-through, especially for members who are not part of a ROSCA or contribution pool. But they are not the same strength as verified payment evidence. The TrustSlip must keep that distinction clear.

6. App Proof Path

Before the workshop, test this exact path:

1. ``/cover``
2. ``/login``
3. ``/app/dashboard``
4. ``/app/community``
5. ``/app/marketplace``
6. ``/app/shop-control``
7. ``/app/trust``
8. ``/app/trust-slip``
9. Public TrustSlip verification page

Each screen should answer one question:

Does this help prove portable trust, or is it noise?

The demo should not explain every page. It should prove one thing:

Community activity becomes portable trust evidence.

7. One-Hour Workshop Flow

0-5 minutes: Welcome and purpose

Explain that this is customer discovery, not a finished product launch. Ask for honest feedback, not polite approval.

5-12 minutes: Founder background and problem

Chuma explains the real problem: many people already have trust, support history, contribution discipline, and community standing, but that trust is informal, invisible, trapped inside one group, and hard to carry into a new place.

12-20 minutes: Two visuals

Use the system architecture map to show the wider trust system.

Use the human journey poster to show the emotional story of people building together.

Make one thing clear:

Contribution is one example of trust evidence. Portable trust is the main story.

20-35 minutes: Live app proof

Walk through only the screens that support Amara's story:

1. Cover and sign-in
2. Dashboard identity and commitment discipline
3. Community context
4. Marketplace or shop context
5. Trust Passport
6. TrustSlip
7. Public verification by an outside person

35-55 minutes: Discovery discussion

Ask participants to challenge the idea:

- What evidence would you need before trusting Amara in Aberdeen?
- Would contribution history matter more than sponsor count?
- Would you trust a TrustSlip with sponsors but no repayment or contribution history?
- What negative information should be shown to make it believable?
- What should remain private inside the full Trust Passport?
- What decision would you be comfortable making from this TrustSlip?
- At what amount or risk level would you ask for more evidence?
- What feels confusing, risky, missing, or unnecessary?

55-60 minutes: Close

Thank participants, explain how their feedback will shape the next version, and ask whether anyone is willing to join a follow-up session.

8. Auditor Roles

Trust / fintech / risk auditor

This person challenges whether the evidence is strong enough:

- Could the system be abused?
- What would a merchant, lender, society, or employer need before trusting it?
- Are any claims too strong?
- What compliance, fraud, identity, or risk questions need to be answered?

Community finance / ROSCA auditor

This person checks whether the TrustSlip reflects how contribution groups really build trust:

- Are payment cycles and post-payout behavior visible enough?
- Does the TrustSlip distinguish membership from proven follow-through?
- Does it show sponsor quality, not just sponsor count?
- Does it respect community governance and social enforcement?
- Does it avoid becoming a fake credit score?

Product / customer discovery auditor

This person watches the users:

- Do participants understand the story?
- Where do they get confused?
- What creates belief?
- What creates doubt?
- What language should change?
- Which parts of the app should be simplified before wider testing?

9. Materials Needed

Prepare only what supports the proof:

- Short slide deck
- System architecture map
- Human journey poster
- One-page participant invitation
- Feedback form
- Live app demo checklist
- Backup screenshots in case Wi-Fi fails
- Trust Passport / TrustSlip example
- Merchant verification example

Do not overload participants with the research audit. Keep the research audit for internal review and auditor preparation.

10. Timing Options

Possible UK time options:

- Tuesday, 19 May 2026, 2:00-3:30pm
- Wednesday, 20 May 2026, 11:00am-12:30pm
- Thursday, 21 May 2026, 5:00-6:30pm

The evening option may be more practical if students are managing exams, work, or travel.

11. Short Email Summary

The GSN customer discovery workshop is a guided pilot session where members of the Nigerian Society at RGU review the platform as potential early users. The session will test whether students understand and believe the idea of portable trust: a person building trust in one community and carrying verified evidence of that trust into another setting.

The session will include a short problem introduction, two visuals, a focused app walkthrough, and an open feedback discussion. The main demo story will follow Amara, who builds a trust record in Lagos and later uses a Trust Passport or TrustSlip in Aberdeen so others can make a more informed decision about support, trade, referral, or opportunity.

The goal is honest feedback on what feels clear, useful, risky, confusing, or missing. A group of 6-12 participants is enough for useful early discovery.

12. Immediate Next Steps

1. Chris and Favour review this clean working brief.
2. Confirm whether the workshop is likely to be in person or online.
3. Confirm the best date and time.
4. Confirm whether the Nigerian Society can gather 6-12 participants.
5. Rehearse the Amara proof path on phone.
6. Prepare the slide deck, feedback form, and backup screenshots.
7. Decide which auditors should review the TrustSlip evidence before the session.

13. Working Principle

The workshop should not ask students to admire the app.

It should ask them to challenge the idea.

The strongest outcome is not polite approval. The strongest outcome is clear feedback on whether GSN's portable trust story makes sense, what evidence people would actually believe, and what must improve before broader testing.